

more behind it ... [Red Bull] spent, for many years, disproportionately in the market to their sales, in order to establish the brand, *and they did a good job.* (emphasis Yoda's)

In introducing Monster, Hansen's did not repeat its mistake. Just look at the number of sales and marketing people they added beginning in 2002 (when Monster was introduced):

	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006
Sales & marketing employees	66	63	114	217	363	591

"They spent heavily on promotions, marketing campaigns, and sales & marketing employees," Yoda writes. "Monster and Rockstar entered the category at about the same time in the 16-oz niche. Being one of the two pioneers, Monster recognized and seized on the opportunity."

Of course, Hansen's didn't "just" spend its time and money on branding and marketing and new-product introductions. They also spent a lot of time focusing on product distribution and the different ways to both reach consumers and earn valuable shelf space with retailers.

"In its early years, in many ways it would be appropriate to call them a think tank," Yoda writes. "They tried different ways to reach consumers.

For their Juice Slam product, they partnered with Costco. With their E2O Energy Water, they tried to sell directly to retail customers. They even put in the lowest bid on a WIC program (similar to food stamps) that gave them the exclusive right to make 100% of the allotted apple juice and mixed fruit juice that the program offers in WIC-approved grocers."

The WIC contract got them in grocery stores that hadn't stocked the company's products before. It opened doors, in other words, for Hansen's products and for ways to create brand awareness.

When they decided to roll out a new energy-drink line, Lost Energy, they again experimented. Instead of going through their regular distribution channel, they decided to use the Dr. Pepper/7-Up network.

They also took advantage of their brand identity. "Their studies showed that drinkers of 16-oz energy beverages tended to be men," Yoda writes. No surprise, given their black can and bear-clawed *M.*